Service and Validity Checklist

FORM 3A NOTICE

Purpose: Use this checklist to verify that the Form 3A notice is internally consistent across the notice and support documents, has been served using a defensible method, and is ready for evidence use if a claim is issued.

The claimant seeks possession of 16 Willow Mews York YO24 3HX relying on Ground 8 (Rent arrears), Ground 10 (Any rent arrears).

Form 3A notice served on 30 April 2026, expiring on 28 May 2026, with proceedings not intended before 28 May 2026.

LANDLORD	**Daniel Mercer**
TENANT	**Ivy Carleton**
PROPERTY	**16 Willow Mews York YO24 3HX**
TENANCY START DATE	**1 January 2024**
NOTICE SERVICE DATE	**30 April 2026**
NOTICE EXPIRY DATE	**28 May 2026**
EARLIEST PROCEEDINGS DATE	**28 May 2026**
GROUNDS RELIED ON	**Ground 8 - Serious rent arrears, Ground 10 - Rent arrears (some arrears)**

Current England notice periods after 1 May 2026: use the longest period that applies where multiple grounds are included.

- 4 months minimum: Grounds 1, 1A, 2, 2ZA, 2ZB, 2ZC, 2ZD, 4A, 6, 6B.
- 2 months minimum: Grounds 5, 5A, 5B, 5C, 5H, 7, 9.
- 4 weeks (28 days) minimum: Grounds 5E, 5F, 5G, 8, 10, 11, 18.
- 2 weeks (14 days) minimum: Grounds 4, 7B, 12, 13, 14A, 14ZA, 15, 17.
- Immediate (0 days): Grounds 7A and 14.
- Where multiple grounds are relied on, use the MAXIMUM notice period.

Service Evidence

Keep With The Pack

- Copy of the served notice
- Completed Form N215 certificate of service or service witness note
- Keep the proof of posting, a copy of the served Form 3A notice, and a record of the address used.
- If service is challenged, be ready to explain why the method chosen complied with the tenancy agreement and why the service date used in the pack is the correct date.

Validity Checks

Before You Rely On The Notice

- Check that the same party names, address, grounds, court name, and notice timeline appear consistently across the Form 3A notice, the support documents, and any court forms.
- Ground 8 should only be advanced as a mandatory ground if the arrears still satisfy the threshold of £3,600.00 at the hearing.
- If arrears grounds are relied on, make sure the arrears schedule and the pleaded figures still match the current rent account.

Notice periods: The required notice period depends on the grounds relied on and can change. If you alter the grounds, the service method, or the intended service date, regenerate the pack so every document uses the same recalculated dates.

After Service

Do Not Do These Things

- Review the pack as a whole before issue so that dates, court details, and ground wording remain aligned.
- Remove empty or unused sections rather than leaving placeholder text or blank visual gaps in court-facing documents.

Risk warning: A possession claim can be delayed or contested if the notice dates, service evidence, or grounds particulars are inconsistent across the pack, even where the underlying arrears or breach evidence is strong.